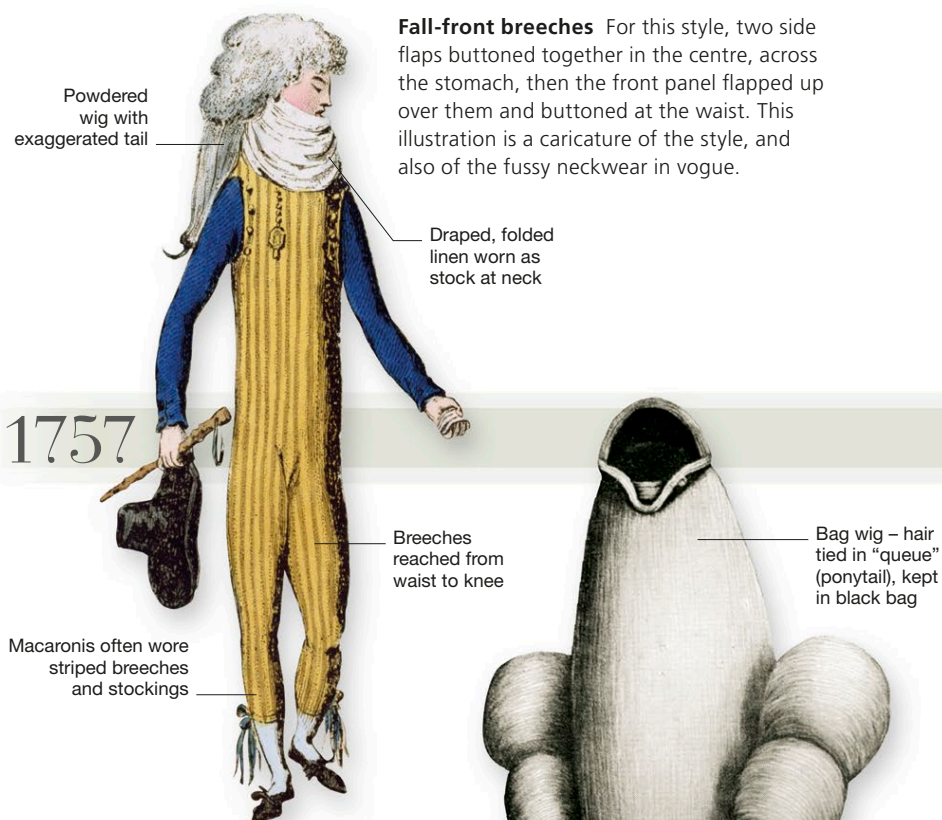


1770–1789

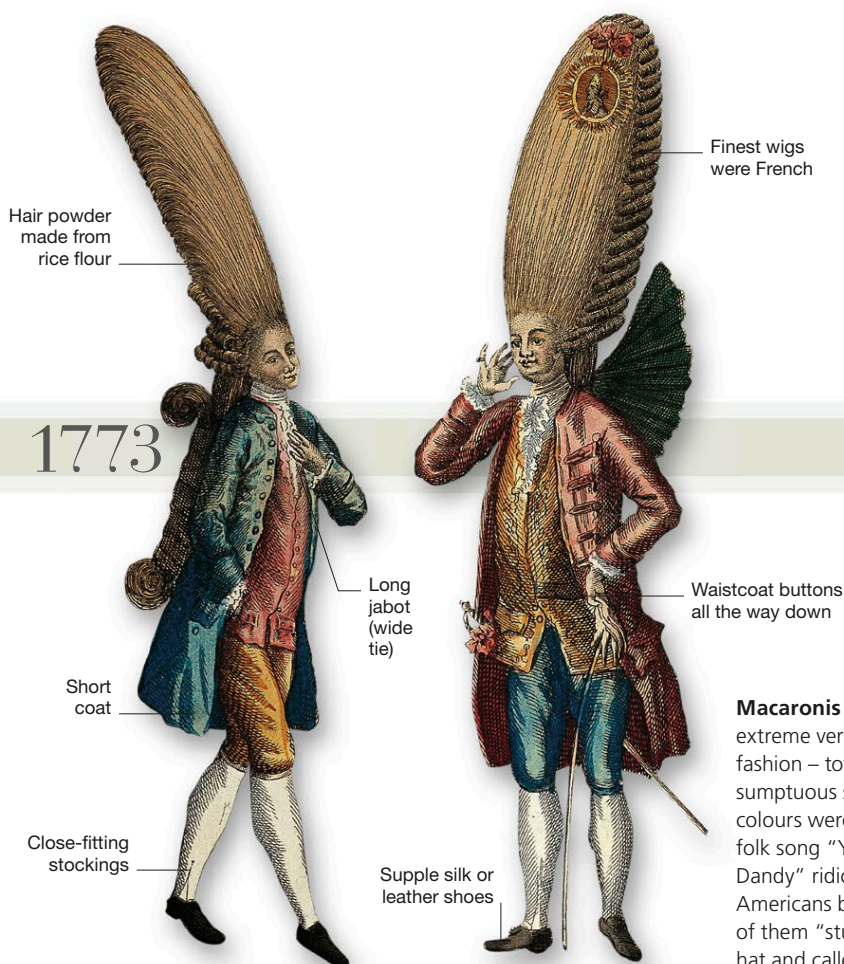
MACARONI TO DANDY

The 1770s saw the final flicker of flamboyant male fashion. Earlier in the century, the term “macaroni” had been coined for young men who affected fussy foreign dress and grooming (other labels were “fop”, “exquisite”, and *élégantes* in France). The name seems to have come from the informal Macaroni Club, made up of young gentlemen back from their Grand Tour, much of it spent in pasta-loving Italy. Then, towards the end of the century, powdered wigs fell from favour and the collared frock coat, based on English sporting dress, became popular. The inspiration for men’s fashion had begun to move from France to England, from formal city to relaxed country, and (during the Age of Enlightenment) from the worship of rank to the belief in democracy. This was reflected in simpler, subtler styles – fashionable men of the time, tastefully free from macaroni excesses, were known as “dandies”.



Satirical prints Caricaturists of the time lampooned the macaronis mercilessly in contemporary illustrations that were distributed in large numbers, and enjoyed by all sections of society. This detail is from a print of a 1773 oil painting titled *Pantheon Macaroni*.

Tight sleeves end with oversized lace ruffles



Macaronis These men wore extreme versions of current fashion – tottering wigs, sumptuous suits, and peacock colours were favourites. The folk song “Yankee Doodle Dandy” ridiculed provincial Americans by claiming one of them “stuck a feather in his hat and called it macaroni”.